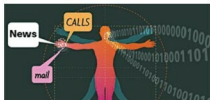


ing with several partners in various verticals to tap these opportunities.

In the energy space, they are working with utilities, hoping to deploy as many as 10 million smart meters supporting Internet Protocol (IP) by the end of the year as against current figures of 2 billion smart meters in operation using 135 varied utility protocols. They are



As the IoT picks up, researchers are figuring out ways to do away with the touch screen and use the body as the user interface (Courtesy: <http://thenetwork.cisco.com>)

also working on migration strategies to smoothen deployment. On the tech front, Cisco has fit an IPv6 stack into a 40kB RAM. The company has also invested in Cohda Wireless, an 802.11p board vendor playing a key role in connecting cars. This and other Cisco-enabled products, such as Streetline, a parking management device, are examples of sensors that will create wondrous opportunities for Big Data players.

Microsoft, Internet of Your Things. Some time ago, Microsoft announced a Windows for IoT platform. But more exciting is the company's acquisition of Azure Intelligent Systems, a key move towards making the IoT more accessible. According to a press statement by a company official, Microsoft is thinking about the Internet of your things and not the Internet of every-

thing, meaning they wish to make the whole concept more user-friendly and accessible to users. How would Azure Intelligent Systems help? It is a solution for people to manage their entire IoT infrastructure from a single site. It is essentially a Cloud-based service designed to manage IoT devices, collect the data they produce and route it to useful tools, including their own Hadoop-based HD Insight, Office 365's Power BI, as well as custom software from Microsoft partners.

Intelligent Systems is a cross-platform service that augments existing infrastructure investments. It connects to devices over IP, and lets you connect to any device, anywhere and get data off that device. Even Linux devices! That is what makes the acquisition critical to Microsoft's IoT strategy. While Windows for IoT helps position Windows as a player in the IoT space, Intelligent Systems helps them span the whole market.

Oracle, small devices to Big Data. Oracle is also betting big on the IoT. Java-enabled devices and engineered Big Data systems are central to the company's plans. They are positioning embedded Java technology as a key enabler of the IoT, and develop Java-based solutions for small-to-large embedded devices, helping reduce costs, improve product quality and speed time-to-market.

While embedded devices are one end of the IoT spectrum, Big Data infrastructure is the other and Oracle has a strategy for that too. The company designs 'engineered systems' that are

Monetising the IoT

While companies are slowly gaining awareness about the IoT, many are still wary about how the infrastructure can actually be monetised. In an inspiring example, Transwestern and Metropolis Investment Holdings, well known in the property management space, renovated their business building systems with sensors and saw quantifiable results. They connected people, processes, data and things to a building-wide IP network.

By integrating everything into a backbone, they could monitor and manage 95,000 network-connected building points centrally, thereby enhancing building efficiency and bringing down operating costs. They could also respond to tenant requests in real time, improving customer experience. Also, by using business intelligence to study energy patterns, they could cut annual energy costs by 21 per cent in the first year.

Why the phone?

In many ways, the smartphone is becoming central to the IoT, with almost every device being connected to a mobile app. How safe is that? In response to a blog post about some IoT gadgets, a reader had replied worriedly that the mobile phone was the object he tended to lose most easily. Now, does that ring a bell for any of you?

pre-integrated to reduce the cost and complexity of IT infrastructures while increasing productivity and performance. ●

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